National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Latrobe, PA	**Accident Number:**	NYC08CA048
Date & Time:	11/28/2007, 1433 EST	**Registration:**	N103JT
Aircraft:	Vans Aircraft RV-8	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 Serious
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

On his third landing of the day, the pilot of an amateur built Vans RV-8 touched down, in a tail low attitude, near the displaced runway threshold. The airplane began to veer left and right, so the pilot applied power and climbed to an altitude of 30 to 50 feet. The airplane then rolled and turned left before it overflew the left edge of the runway and parallel taxiway, while continuing to turn past a heading perpendicular to the runway centerline. The airplane continued the left turn, in an approximate 30-degree bank, and began to descend toward a low wetland adjacent to the runway. The aircraft struck the ground left wingtip first, and the left wing and left main gear separated from the airframe. The airplane then cartwheeled counterclockwise coming to rest upright on the right main landing gear and forward fuselage. This was the pilot's second incident in an RV-8. Approximately one year prior to the accident, in a different RV-8, the pilot also experienced a loss of control while practicing landings, during which the airplane veered off the left side of the runway and struck a taxiway light.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The pilot's failure to maintain directional control during landing.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF CONTROL - IN FLIGHT
Phase of Operation: LANDING - FLARE/TOUCHDOWN

Findings
1. (C) DIRECTIONAL CONTROL - NOT MAINTAINED - PILOT IN COMMAND

Occurrence #2: IN FLIGHT COLLISION WITH TERRAIN/WATER
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ABORTED

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Private	**Age:**	60, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	Front
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 3 With Waivers/Limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	03/01/2006
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	475 hours (Total, all aircraft), 3 hours (Total, this make and model)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Vans Aircraft	**Registration:**	N103JT
Model/Series:	RV-8	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	Yes
Airworthiness Certificate:	Experimental	**Serial Number:**	80580
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel	**Seats:**	2
Date/Type of Last Inspection:		**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	1800 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:		**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:		**Engine Model/Series:**	O-320
Registered Owner:	On file	**Rated Power:**	160
Operator:	On file	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	LBE, 1185 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	
Observation Time:	1440 EST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Scattered / 20000 ft agl	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	4 knots /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	10°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.33 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	7°C / -7°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Latrobe, PA (LBE)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	(LBE)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	EST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Arnold Palmer Regional Airport (LBE)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	1185 ft	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	23	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	8500 ft / 100 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Traffic Pattern

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 Serious	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 Serious	**Latitude, Longitude:**	40.275833, -79.404722

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Todd G Gunther	**Report Date:**	03/31/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	Andrew Pierce; Allegheny County		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

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The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.